



MEGHALAYA BOARD OF SCHOOL EDUCATION
HEADQUARTERS :: TURA.

NOTIFICATION No. - 276
Dated Tura, the 27th Sept, 2025.

Meghalaya Board of School Education is pleased to notify for information of all Secondary Schools that the Education Department, Government of Meghalaya has developed Guidebooks titled "**CM IMPACT Guidebook for SSLC Examination 2026**" for Additional English, Computer Science, Garo and Khasi subjects for Class X.

All concerned are requested to download the same from our official website www.mbose.in

Sd/-

Shri D. D. Sangma, IAS,
Executive Chairman,

Meghalaya Board of School Education,

Tura

Memo No. MBOSE/AW/S-Cur/215/25/26180-220 Dated Tura, the 27th Sept, 2025.

Copy to:

1. The Commissioner & Secretary to the Government of Meghalaya, Education Department, Meghalaya, Shillong, for information.
2. The Director, Educational Research & Training, Meghalaya, Laitumkhrah, Nongrimmaw, Shillong - 793011.
3. The Director, School Education & Literacy, Meghalaya, Shillong - 793003.
4. The Director, Accreditation & Controller of Examinations, MBOSE, Tura.
5. The Director (Admin.), Regional Office, MBOSE, Shillong.
6. All District School Education Officers with a request to circulate the Notification to all Secondary Schools under their respective jurisdictions.
7. All Heads of the Institutions of Secondary & Higher Secondary Schools.
8. The Deputy Director (I.T.E.S.), MBOSE, Tura to upload it in the MBOSE website.

Jno6
Chief Academic Officer,

Meghalaya Board of School Education,
Tura.

ADDITIONAL ENGLISH

CLASS X

EXISTING COURSE

2025-2026

Guidebook for Teachers

Ans. D

Section-A (1 mark)

Multiple choice questions (MCQ):

1. The clown's jokes fell flat, for they were the kind of jokes that used to raise a laugh before

- A. 1929
- B. 1939
- C. 1949
- D. 1959

Ans. B

2. When the man appeared, the manager's wife tried to:

- A. welcome the newcomer
- B. introduce the newcomer
- C. size up the newcomer
- D. send the newcomer away

Ans. C

3. The manager agreed to take the stranger because:

- A. he could make a good clown
- B. he needed a helper
- C. he could perform a dangerous act
- D. he had a sense of humour

Ans. C

4. At length, the man emerged from behind a screen and slowly

- A. walked towards the manager and his wife
- B. walked away from the manager and his wife
- C. walked towards the platform
- D. walked towards the ladder

Ans. A

5. The man was standing breast-high in the tank

- A. before performing the dangerous act
- B. after changing into his bathing suit
- C. after performing the dangerous act
- D. None of the above

Ans. C

6. The last offer to the stranger was

- A. fifteen pounds
- B. twenty pounds
- C. twenty five pounds
- D. thirty pounds

7. The story, 'A High Dive' was written by

- A. Luigi Pirandello
- B. Frank R. Stockton
- C. L. P. Hartley
- D. Victor Hugo

Ans. C

8. The manager said he could not do business with the stranger because:

- A. the stranger had failed to perform his task
- B. he was too arrogant
- C. he disliked the stranger
- D. he thought the stranger was not satisfied with the offer

Ans. D

9. The man turned down the offer because

- A. he did not like the place
- B. he did not like what he had done
- C. he did not like the manager
- D. he was not satisfied with the offer

Ans. B

10. How many times had the man performed the high dive?

- A. One time
- B. Two times
- C. Three times
- D. Four times

Ans. A

11. The manager pointed to a _____ ladder:

- A. silver plated
- B. aluminum plated
- C. chromium plated
- D. bronze plated

Ans. C

12. The stranger could not stand upright on the platform because

- A. he was too tall
- B. he was scared
- C. he was trying to find his balance
- D. the platform was slippery

Ans. A

13. The water trickled from his _____ hair on to his shoulder:

- A. curly
- B. matted
- C. straight
- D. long

Ans. B

14. The stranger claimed that he could dive from a height of

- A. forty feet.
- B. eighty feet
- C. sixty feet
- D. thirty feet

Ans. C

15. 'I don't see what we can do about the comic side' These words were spoken by

- A. the circus manager
- B. the manager's wife
- C. the stranger
- D. the escort

Ans. A

16. 'The Postmaster' was written by

- A. R. K Narayan.
- B. A.K. Ramanujan.
- C. Rabindranath Tagore.
- D. Ruskin Bond.

Ans. C.

17. How old was Ratan?

- A. eleven to twelve years old.
- B. twelve to thirteen years old.
- C. thirteen to fourteen years old
- D. fourteen to fifteen years old.

Ans. B.

18. The post office at Ulapur was set up by

- A. the people of Ulapur.
- B. the postmaster.
- C. the Government of India.
- D. the British manager

Ans. D

19. When the postmaster called Ratan one afternoon, she was stretched out under

- A. a guava tree
- B. an apple tree
- C. a banyan tree
- D. a willow tree

Ans. A

20. The postmaster was resigning from his post because

- A. he did not like his job
- B. the salary was too low
- C. he did not like Ratan
- D. his application for a transfer was rejected

Ans. D.

21. In the evenings, smoke curled up from the

- A. village roof-tops.
- B. village cow-sheds
- C. indigo factory
- D. postmaster's kitchen

Ans. B

22. During the month of Sraban, _____ in Ulapur:

- A. the sun shone brightly
- B. there were cyclones
- C. it was very cold
- D. rain fell continuously

Ans. D

23. What did the postmaster do before he left?

- A. He promised Ratan that he would come back.
- B. He offered to take Ratan with him
- C. He offered Ratan some money.
- D. He ignored Ratan and did not speak to her.

Ans. C

24. The postmaster was originally from

- A. Calcutta
- B. Madras
- C. Ulapur
- D. Bombay

Ans. A

25. How did Ratan react to the money offered by the postmaster?

- A. She accepted it with gratitude
- B. She threw it away
- C. She refused to take it
- D. She gave it to the new postmaster.

Ans. C

26. The postmaster's family consisted of his

- A. father, mother and elder brother
- B. sister and elder brother
- C. father, younger brother and elder sister
- D. mother, younger brother and elder sister

Ans. D

27. After recovering from his illness, the postmaster wrote at once to

- A. his head office in Calcutta
- B. his head office in Ulapur
- C. the head office of the Indigo factory
- D. his mother in Calcutta

Ans. A

28. The rainwater from the thatched roof dripped on to

- A. a plastic bucket
- B. a bronze vessel
- C. an earthenware dish
- D. a steel bowl

Ans. C

29. In the story, 'The Postmaster', the tendency of human nature is

- A. to always have high hopes
- B. to cling to false hopes
- C. to use logic and reason whenever there is a problem
- D. to cling to wealth

Ans. B

30. Occasionally, the postmaster would sit on _____ in a corner of his large hut.

- A. a wooden chair
- B. a sofa
- C. a low wooden stool
- D. the floor

Ans. C

31. The story 'The Lady or The Tiger' was written by:

- A. Frank R. Stockton
- B. Roald Dahl
- C. Luigi Pirandello
- D. L.P Hartley

Ans. A

32. Why was the princess in great agony?

- A. She failed to possess the secret of the doors.
- B. She could not come to the conclusion whether to guide or misguide her lover.
- C. Her lover was indifferent to her.
- D. Her lover had never truly loved her.

Ans. B

33. The young man went to the door and opened it

- A. with some hesitation
- B. with some fear and hesitation

- C. without any feeling of hope
- D. without the slightest hesitation

Ans. D

34. What were those 'fateful portals'?

- A. The entrance doors leading to the arena
- B. The doors beneath the king's throne
- C. The doors which decided the fate of the accused
- D. Fateful decisions to declare war

Ans. C

35. If the accused was innocent, he was rewarded

- A. after the trial
- B. on the spot
- C. only if the king desired to
- D. as per the choice of the accused

Ans. B

36. 'She was the apple of his eye'. Who was 'she' referred to?

- A. The princess
- B. The beautiful lady
- C. The dancing maiden
- D. The queen

Ans. A

37. 'She thought these glances were perceived and even returned' These glances referred to

- A. the glances between the princess and her lover.
- B. the glances between the audience and the youth.
- C. the glances between the lady and her lover.
- D. the glances between the king and the youth.

Ans. C

38. The princess' arm lay on the

- A. cushioned parapet
- B. side of her chair
- C. wooden platform
- D. king's throne

Ans. A

39. What custom did the courtier have to follow?

- A. To raise his hand at the king.
- B. To greet the king.
- C. To bow before the king.
- D. To kneel before the king.

Ans. C

40. The young courtier's eyes were fixed

- A. on the king
- B. on his beloved princess
- C. on the doors
- D. on the audience

Ans. B

41. Where did the king and his court sit in the arena?

- A. Under the twin doors.
- B. Next to the twin doors.
- C. Behind the twin doors
- D. Opposite the twin doors.

Ans. D

42. Which bells would be rung if the accused opened the door that had a tiger behind it?

- A. Gay brass bells
- B. Doleful iron bells
- C. Gay steel bells
- D. Doleful brass bells

Ans. B

43. How was the king characterized in the story, 'The Lady or The Tiger'?

- A. Civilized and cultured
- B. Semi-barbaric with a blend of culture
- C. Cruel and tyrannical
- D. Kind-hearted and benevolent

Ans. B

44. The semi-barbaric king had a daughter who was

- A. known for her foolish nature
- B. very civilized
- C. passionate and commanding
- D. weak but kind

Ans. C

45. The thick doors were heavily curtained with _____

- A. skins on the inside
- B. carpets on the outside
- C. blankets on the inside
- D. leather on the outside

Ans. A

46. What was Rama Rao's source of income after losing his job?

- A. The prize money from winning the puzzles.

B. The rent from the extension.

C. The money he had inherited as security.

D. The loans he got from his friends.

Ans. B

47. Their shirts show 'tear and frays', means

- A. their shirts have been totally damaged
- B. their shirts have become smaller in size
- C. their shirts have become torn with too much use
- D. their shirts have rough designs

Ans. C

48. Who is the protagonist of the story, 'Out of Business'?

- A. Rama Rao
- B. Rama Rao's wife
- C. The financier
- D. The news-agent

Ans. A

49. The name of the fictional town mentioned in the text is

- A. Calcutta
- B. Bombay
- C. Lucknow
- D. Malgudi

Ans. D

50. For _____ years Rama Rao's business brought him enough money.

- A. four years
- B. five years
- C. six years
- D. seven years

Ans. B

51. Rama Rao was planning to buy a

- A. car
- B. house
- C. shop
- D. bus

Ans. A

52. How often were Rama Rao's children given new clothes?

- A. Twice in a month
- B. Once in three months
- C. Once in six months
- D. Once in three months

Ans. B

53. The name of the journal was:

- A. The Statesman
- B. The Telegraph
- C. The Captain
- D. The Herald

Ans. C

54. 'The Captain' consisted of

- A. four pages
- B. two pages
- C. three pages
- D. six pages

Ans. A

55. The journal offered every week a first prize of

- A. five thousand rupees
- B. four thousand rupees
- C. six thousand rupees
- D. eight thousand rupees

Ans. B

56. The phrase 'build castles in the air' means

- A. To have unrealistic or impractical dreams
- B. To build castles in the sky
- C. To build a wall around the castle
- D. To build a high wall around a fort.

Ans. A

57. What was Rama Rao's only source of income after he lost his business?

- A. The rent from the company
- B. The money that he inherited
- C. The interest that he received from the bank
- D. The rent from their bungalow

Ans. D

58. How much money did Rama Rao ask from his wife for sending four entries of the puzzle?

- A. Six rupees
- B. Ten rupees
- C. Fifteen rupees
- D. Five rupees

Ans. C

59. How did Rama Rao feel after realizing that he had made many mistakes in the puzzle?

- A. He was disturbed for a moment
- B. He felt relieved that he had tried

C. He felt depressed and hopeless

D. He was determined to try again

Ans. C

60. What good news did Rama Rao receive from his wife on returning home?

- A. The tenants were ready to offer good cash for the house
- B. The tenants were ready to vacate the bungalow
- C. The tenants were ready to help him in repairing the house
- D. All of the above

Ans. A

61. The phrase 'a bolt from the blue' means

- A. a piece of news
- B. a fortunate incident
- C. a sudden and unexpected event
- D. leaving suddenly and quickly

Ans. C

62. What message does the story 'War' portray?

- A. It portrays the depth of human sorrow during a war
- B. It portrays bloodshed of one particular country
- C. It portrays lack of respect towards each other.
- D. It portrays that only boys of twenty devoted their life to their country.

Ans. A

63. The story 'War' was written by

- A. L.P Hartley
- B. Luigi Pirandello
- C. Leo Tolstoy
- D. Frank R. Stockton

Ans. B

64. 'Everyone should stop crying; everyone should laugh, as I do...' Who was the speaker?

- A. The first passenger
- B. The second passenger
- C. The fat red-faced man
- D. The author

Ans. C

65. 'Then ... is your son really dead'? Who uttered these words?

- A. The thin husband
- B. The first passenger
- C. The red-faced man

D. The fat woman

Ans. D

66. What did the red-faced man snatch in haste from his pocket?

A. A handkerchief

B. A wallet

C. A pen

D. A piece of paper

Ans. A

67. The bulky woman was so pleased to hear everyone joining in _____ that brave father.

A. applauding

B. congratulating

C. encouraging

D. blaming

Ans. B

68. The woman under the _____ was twisting and wriggling at times, growling like a wild animal

A. small coat

B. fur coat

C. fawn coat

D. big coat

Ans. D) big coat

69. Who should consider the feelings of the children when they are twenty?

A. The soldiers

B. The relatives

C. The parents

D. The older children

Ans. C

70. Where did the passengers' conversation take place?

A. In a second class railway compartment

B. In a first class railway compartment

C. At the railway station

D. At the bus station

Ans. A

71. The couple received a wire which said that:

A. their son was sick.

B. they had to send off their son.

C. their son was returning home.

D. their son had died in the war.

Ans. B

72. If country exists, if country is a natural necessity, somebody _____

A. must keep it clean.

B. must go to attack it.

C. must go to defend it.

D. must develop it.

Ans. C

73. According to the red-faced man, the sons go to the front when they are twenty because

A. they are forced to by their parents

B. they feel a sense of duty towards their country

C. they have no other option

D. they want to make their parents proud

Ans. B

74. The war was taking away her only son, a boy of

A. eighteen years

B. nineteen years

C. twenty-one years

D. twenty years

Ans. D

75. The husband of the bulky woman thanked the passengers because

A. they offered him a seat

B. they helped his wife and made room for her

C. they carried his luggage

D. they offered food to them

Ans. B

76. How old was Lucy when Nature adopted her?

A. Two years

B. Three years

C. Four years

D. Five years

Ans. B

77. The poem, 'The Education of Nature' was written by:

A. William Wordsworth

B. Lord Tennyson

C. William Blake

D. Louis Untermeyer

Ans. A

78. She shall be _____ as the fawn

A. active

B. playful

C. sportive

D. mild

Ans. C

79. And hers shall be the breathing _____

- A. balm
- B. calm
- C. power
- D. palm

Ans. A

80. What role does Nature play in Lucy's life?

- A. It is a threat to her well being
- B. It is indifferent to her existence
- C. It shapes and influences her growth
- D. It has no significance in her life

Ans. C

81. 'She died, and left to me this heath'. In the given line, the word 'heath' means

- A. a big meadow
- B. an area of flat unused land
- C. a productive land
- D. a farmland

Ans. B

82. 'The work was done' Which work is referred to here?

- A. The education of Lucy
- B. The adoption of Lucy
- C. The death of Lucy
- D. The union of Lucy with nature

Ans. A

83. What does the expression 'mute insensate' mean?

- A. Inability to see things
- B. Inanimate objects
- C. Living things
- D. Opaque objects

Ans. B

84. After Lucy died, the poet is left with:

- A. only memories of her.
- B. no memories of her at all.
- C. suicidal thoughts.
- D. regretful memories.

Ans. A

85. What will lend its state to the maiden?

- A. The stars
- B. The storm
- C. The willow tree
- D. The floating clouds

Ans. D

86. What will be dear to Lucy?

- A. The Sun
- B. The moon

C. The stars

D. The planets

Ans. C

87. What shall Lucy hear in secret places?

- A. Songs of birds
- B. Murmuring sound
- C. Sound of bells
- D. Voices from heaven

Ans. B

88. The poem "IF" was written by :

- A. Louis Untermeyer
- B. William Wordsworth
- C. Edwin Markham
- D. Rudyard Kipling

Ans. B

89. But make allowance for their _____ too.

- A. doubting
- B. anger
- C. question
- D. hatred

Ans. A

90. According to Kipling, what should we do when we are lied about?

- A. We should also tell lies about them.
- B. We should ignore it.
- C. We should fight back with anger.
- D. We should not deal in lies ourselves.

Ans. D

91. If you can talk with _____ and keep your virtue

- A. friends
- B. neighbours
- C. crowds
- D. kings

Ans. C

92. The line 'If you can keep your head when all about you are losing theirs' means:

- A. We should avoid stressful situations.
- B. We should avoid people who give us problems.
- C. We should maintain our composure even in difficult situations.
- D. We should help others when they lose their composure.

Ans. C.

93. What is the main theme of the poem, 'IF'?

- A. Advice that fathers should give their sons
- B. Hard work and determination
- C. Love for oneself
- D. Ideal virtues that one should develop to succeed

Ans. D

94. What does Kipling refer to as 'two imposters'?

- A. Success and Failure.
- B. Triumph and Disaster.
- C. Joy and Sorrow.
- D. Hope and Despair

Ans. B.

95. What is meant by "fill the unforgiving minute with sixty seconds' worth of distance run"?

- A. To make the most of every moment
- B. To run continuously without rest
- C. To forgive others quickly
- D. To measure time accurately

Ans. A

96. When we face loss and defeat, Kipling advises us to:

- A. take a break from what we are doing.
- B. start again from the beginning.
- C. find the person responsible for our loss.
- D. give up and never try again.

Ans. B

97. What does Kipling promise to the person who follows all the advice given?

- A. Success in studies and business
- B. Fame and fortune
- C. Health and wealth
- D. The Earth and everything in it.

Ans. D

98. Kipling says that if we are being lied about

- A. we should also lie about them
- B. we should not deal in lies
- C. we should avoid the people who lied about us.
- D. we should confront the people who lied about us.

Ans. B

99. If neither foes nor _____ friends can hurt you:

- A. loyal
- B. trustworthy
- C. helpful
- D. loving

Ans. D

100. If we lose in a game of 'pitch and toss', we should

- A. never speak about our loss
- B. tell everyone about our loss
- C. never take another risk
- D. tell our loved ones about our loss

Ans. A

101. If you can dream and not make dreams your _____

A. master

B. slave

C. aim

D. goal

Ans. A

102. If you can wait and not _____

- A. be tired by waiting
- B. be angry with the people who make you wait
- C. be tempted to run away
- D. be restless while waiting

Ans. A

103. If you can talk with crowds and keep your _____

- A. humility
- B. virtue
- C. character
- D. goodness

Ans. B

104. The poem 'If' is addressed to

- A. the poet's son
- B. the poet's daughter
- C. the poet's nephew
- D. the poet's father

Ans. A

105. Name the poet of the poem 'A River'

- A. R.K Narayan
- B. Rabindranath Tagore
- C. A.K Ramanujan
- D. Sarojini Naidu

Ans. C

106. In summer the river dries to a trickle because

- A. the river is flooded
- B. the river has very little water
- C. the watergates are clogged
- D. the river is completely dried up

Ans. B

107. The poets sang only of

- A. the temples
- B. the pregnant woman
- C. the cities
- D. the flood

Ans. D

108. How do the exposed wet stones in the river look like?

- A. Crocodiles basking in the sun
- B. Sleepy crocodiles
- C. Sleepy cows

D. Buffaloes basking in the sun

Ans. B

109. The people everywhere talked about:

A. the water receding

B. the water drying to a trickle

C. the water rising

D. the pregnant woman expecting identical twins

Ans. C

110. The flood carried away

A. three village houses

B. a couple of cows

C. a pregnant woman

D. All of the above

Ans. D

111. The river has water enough to be poetic about only

A. once a year

B. twice a year

C. thrice a year

D. None of the above

Ans. A

112. The flood carried away three village houses in the

A. first hour

B. first half-hour

C. second hour

D. second half-hour

Ans. B

113. None of the poets spoke in verse of

A. the pregnant woman

B. Gopi and Brinda

C. three village houses

D. cities of temples

Ans. A

114. The twins were perhaps kicking at _____ walls even before birth.

A. coloured

B. blank

C. empty

D. thick

Ans. B

115. The water gates are clogged by:

A. straw and women's hair

B. plastic bottles

C. straw and plastic bags

D. dead cows and buffaloes

Ans. A

116. The river carried away one pregnant woman expecting:

A. fraternal twins

B. triplets

C. quadruplets

D. identical twins

Ans. D

117. What do the poets of Madurai typically focus on in their poems?

A. The river during summer

B. The pregnant woman and the cows

C. The floods in the river

D. The daily lives of the people

Ans. C

118. Madurai is a city well known for:

A. Baul singers

B. continuous floods

C. pottery works

D. temples and poets

Ans. D

119. A. K Ramanujan is angry with the old and new poets because they write only about:

A. the river during the dry season

B. the cows and the pregnant woman

C. the river when it floods

D. the suffering of the people

Ans. C

120. The poem 'Swimmers' was written by

A. Louis Untermeyer

B. Luigi Pirandello

C. L. P. Hartley

D. Victor Hugo

Ans. A

121. Existing in a vigour _____ and roomy.

A. green

B. cool

C. fresh

D. clean

Ans. D

122. What does the swimmer notice facing the bath-house?

- A. A group of children
- B. A group of men
- C. The poet
- D. Another swimmer

Ans. B

123. The swimmer had just finished a game of

- A. badminton
- B. football
- C. tennis
- D. volleyball

Ans. C

124. The swimmer rushed past _____ of clover.

- A. lakes
- B. fields
- C. gardens
- D. beds

Ans. A

125. The swimmer had to pass along the edge of backyards full of _____

- A. clover
- B. oaks
- C. hedges
- D. drying wash

Ans. D

126. What is 'life' according to Louis Untermeyer?

- A. a bed of roses
- B. an adventure
- C. a long and vivid holiday
- D. a glowing waste of spendthrift hours

Ans. B

127. What does the poet compare the waves to?

- A. A cat with a hundred claws
- B. A dog with a hundred paws
- C. A cat with a hundred nails
- D. None of the above

Ans. A

128. What did the swimmer do after he lurched out of the foam?

- A. He dived headlong into the foremost breaker
- B. He grappled with the wave
- C. He rode the wave
- D. He played with the wave

Ans. C

129. 'I could not see the heavy thing they carried.' What is the 'heavy thing' referred to here?

- A. a dead animal
- B. a dead body
- C. a sack of pebbles
- D. a sack of sand

Ans. B

130. Beat the great wave that _____ exults

- A. rapidly
- B. continuously
- C. tirelessly
- D. endlessly

Ans. D

131. The same persistent _____ and the glowing waste.

- A. stroke
- B. call
- C. struggle
- D. cry

Ans. C

132. What does the swimmer do to the oak trees?

- A. He kicks them with his right foot
- B. He swings his racket at them.
- C. He swings his right hand at them
- D. He cuts them with an axe.

Ans. B

133. The swimmers are symbols of

- A. people who face life's challenges bravely
- B. people who like to swim
- C. children playing in water
- D. individuals who enjoy water sports

Ans. A

134. _____ a private road, along the edge

- A. Crossing
- B. Cleaning
- C. Jumping
- D. Constructing

Ans. C

135. What social issue is mentioned in the poem, 'The Man With The Hoe'?

- A. Racial discrimination
- B. Unemployment

C. Exploitation of the working class

D. Poverty

Ans. C

136. According to the poem, who is responsible for the condition of man?

A. God Almighty

B. Working people

C. Nature

D. Masters and rulers of the world

Ans. D

137. Who are the 'masters, lords and rulers in all lands'?

A. The working class

B. The wealthy and privileged class

C. The political leaders

D. The religious figures

Ans. B

138. What is the main message of the poem 'The Man With The Hoe'?

A. The beauty of rural life

B. The importance of hard work

C. Injustice and social inequality

D. The power of nature

Ans. C

139. Bowed by the weight of _____

A. years

B. centuries

C. ages

D. generations

Ans. B

140. Is this the dream He dreamed who shaped the _____

A. suns

B. stars

C. moons

D. planets

Ans. A

141. What does the line 'Make right the immemorial infamies' refer to?

A. The recent accomplishment of humanity

B. The long standing injustices and wrongs in society

C. The future potential of society

D. the historical achievements of leaders

Ans. B

142. To have _____ over sea and land

A. power

B. right

C. dominion

D. control

Ans. C

143. 'What gulfs between him and the seraphim!'

The word 'seraphim' refers to:

A. an angel of the highest rank

B. an angel of the lowest rank

C. a prophet

D. a fairy

Ans. A

144. This _____ thing distorted and soul-quenched.

A. ugly

B. monstrous

C. terrible

D. dumb

Ans. B

145. The Lord God made and gave man:

A. dominion over sea and land

B. dominion over the stars and the heavens

C. the power over lesser men

D. the power to mark his ways upon the ancient deep.

Ans. A

146. What does the bent body of the body of the 'man with the hoe' symbolize?

A. Strength and resilience

B. Exhaustion and dehumanization

C. Joy and contentment

D. Physical fitness

Ans. B

147. According the poet, the man has been robbed of his

A. home

B. money

C. humanity and soul

D. family

Ans. C

148. The two classes of people mentioned in the poem 'The Man With The Hoe' are:

- A. wise and foolish people
- B. middle and upper class
- C. labour and ruling class
- D. literate and illiterate people

Ans. C

149. How does the poet describe the man with the hoe?

- A. Negligent
- B. Hardworking
- C. Lively
- D. Lazy

Ans. B

150. What does Hermia mean when she says, 'The course of true love never did run smooth'?

- A. True love is always easy and effortless
- B. True love often faces obstacles and challenges
- C. True love is smooth and straightforward
- D. True love is only for the rich

Ans. B

151. 'It is as if you are his figure that he sculpted in wax.' Who utters these words?

- A. Egeus
- B. Theseus
- C. Demetrius
- D. Lysander

Ans. B

152. What does Puck decide to do when he sees the craftsmen rehearsing in the woods?

- A. Change the play
- B. Act in it if he had the opportunity
- C. Direct the play
- D. Make the actors invisible

Ans. B

153. Hippolyta thinks that the stories narrated by the lovers are

- A. strange
- B. extraordinary
- C. lovely
- D. surreal

Ans. A

154. What does Oberon want from Titania?

- A. Her fairy kingdom

B. Her crown

C. The changeling boy

D. Her love

Ans. C

155. How does Puck prevent Demetrius and Lysander from fighting?

- A. By freezing them
- B. By transforming their weapons to weeds
- C. By squeezing the love potion onto their eyelids
- D. By mimicking their voices and leading them astray

Ans. D

156. Who blesses Theseus and Hippolyta with a magical charm at the end of the play?

- A. Puck
- B. Oberon
- C. Attendants
- D. Titania

Ans. C

157. Why does Bottom object to some scenes in the play?

- A. He feels that there are things that will never please the audience
- B. He thinks the audience, especially the children, will be scared
- C. He believes that the scenes are too short
- D. He wants to rewrite the entire play

Ans. A

158. Francis Flute is a

- A. weaver
- B. bellows-mender
- C. tinker
- D. tailor

Ans. B

159. Theseus expects Hermia to give her final decision

- A. by the next full moon
- B. by the next new moon
- C. the following day
- D. in a week's time

Ans. B

160. The Athenian craftsmen decide to stage a play called

- A. The Love of Pyramus and Thisbe

- B. The Tragedy of Pyramus and Thisbe
 - C. The Death of Pyramus and Thisbe
 - D. The Comedy of Pyramus and Thisbe
- Ans. C

161. Who is Nedar?
- A. The father of Hippolyta
 - B. The father of Hermia
 - C. The uncle of Demetrius
 - D. The father of Helena
- Ans. D

162. Theseus says that his hounds have been bred from _____ dams and sires.
- A. Arabian
 - B. Roman
 - C. Spartan
 - D. Greek
- Ans. C

163. Bottom asks Peter Quince to write a _____ on his dreams.
- A. story
 - B. prologue
 - C. ballad
 - D. play
- Ans. C

164. Titania tells Bottom that she finds him
- A. both wise and beautiful
 - B. neither wise nor beautiful
 - C. handsome but foolish
 - D. courteous and polite
- Ans. A

165. Which proverb does Puck use to end the song after squeezing the antidote on Lysander's eyelids?
- A. Love is blind
 - B. Every man shall have his own woman
 - C. All's well that ends well
 - D. Love conquers all
- Ans. B

166. What does Snout fear about the lion's role in the play?
- A. That the costume will be too heavy.
 - B. That it will frighten the ladies.
 - C. That it will not look realistic enough
 - D. That Snug cannot play the role.
- Ans. B

167. The Duke tells Hippolyta that he feels sorry because
- A. he does not want to marry her.
 - B. he has been unfaithful to her.
 - C. he has hurt her and her people in the war.
 - D. All of the above
- Ans. C

168. 'Athens did seem a paradise to me'. Who among the following says so?
- A. Helena
 - B. Hermia
 - C. Hippolyta
 - D. Titania
- Ans. B

169. What are Titania and Bottom doing when Oberon found them?
- A. They are singing with the fairies.
 - B. They are preparing for their wedding.
 - C. They are quarrelling.
 - D. They are asleep on the bed of flowers.
- Ans. D

170. Puck says that he can girdle round the earth in only _____ minutes.
- A. forty
 - B. thirty
 - C. fifty
 - D. twenty
- Ans. A

171. "I will wed you in another key, with pomp, with triumph and with revelry." Who speaks these words and to whom?
- A. Lysander to Hermia.
 - B. Demetrius to Hermia
 - C. Oberon to Titania.
 - D. Theseus to Hippolyta
- Ans. D

172. The Amazons are a tribe of women warriors in _____ mythology.
- A. Roman
 - B. Greek
 - C. African
 - D. Egyptian
- Ans. B

173. Hermia tells Lysander that she can water the _____ in her cheeks with her tears.

- A. lilies
- B. daisies
- C. roses
- D. pansies

Ans. C

174. Helena compares Hermia's eyes to :

- A. stars that guide travellers at night
- B. planets that orbit the sun
- C. stars that guide sailors at night
- D. hawthorn buds that appear in the spring

Ans. C

175. Lysander's aunt lives in a village _____ away from Athens.

- A. twenty-one miles
- B. twenty-one leagues
- C. seven miles
- D. sevenkilometres

Ans. A

176. Oberon has just returned from the farthest mountain range of:

- A. Nepal
- B. India
- C. Greece
- D. Rome

Ans. B

177. The 'love -in- idleness' is a:

- A. white flower which turned purple
- B. purple flower which turned white
- C. yellow flower which turned purple
- D. purple flower which turned yellow

Ans. A

178. Diana's herb is

- A. an antidote
- B. an antibiotic
- C. a stimulant
- D. a depressant

Ans. A

179. A residence for monks or priests:

- A. Convent
- B. Dormitory
- C. Monastery
- D. Refectory

Ans. C

180. To look at someone in an angry or threatening way

- A. Glower
- B. Gnaw
- C. Gnash
- D. Grind

Ans. A

181. A doctor who specializes in the diagnosis and treatment of heart diseases:

- A. Dermatologist
- B. Urologist
- C. Cardiologist
- D. Neurologist

Ans. C

182. The feeling that something unpleasant is going to happen.

- A. Premonition
- B. Imagination
- C. Phobia
- D. Delusion

Ans. A

183. One who collects coins is called a

- A. collector
- B. philatelist
- C. calligrapher
- D. numismatist

Ans. D

184. The day when both day and night are of approximately equal length is

- A. equilibrium
- B. equine
- C. equator
- D. equinox

Ans. D

185. A period of one thousand years is

- A. millennium
- B. centenary
- C. century
- D. decade

Ans. A

186. The place where public, government or historical records are kept is called

- A. a pantry
- B. a coffer
- C. a scullery
- D. an archive

Ans. D

187. Decorative handwriting is called

- A. calligraphy
- B. cursive
- C. scribble
- D. stenography

Ans. A

188. A person who dishonestly pretends to be somebody else is called

- A. knave
- B. actor
- C. villain
- D. imposter

Ans. D

189. _____ were men who used to fight with weapons at public shows in an arena.

- A. Gladiators
- B. Swordsmen
- C. Archers
- D. Wrestlers

Ans. A

190. Words inscribed on a tomb:

- A. Epitome
- B. Epistle
- C. Epilogue
- D. Epitaph

Ans. D

191. List giving the meaning of difficult words at the end of a book:

- A. Glossary
- B. Catalogue
- C. Document
- D. Dictionary

Ans. A

192. A fear of closed and dark spaces is

- A. aerophobia
- B. pyrophobia
- C. claustrophobia
- D. xenophobia

Ans. C

193. To make a mountain out of a mole hill means to:

- A. exaggerate
- B. manipulate
- C. exonerate
- D. inaugurate

Ans. A

194. A name adopted by an author in his writing:

- A. Nickname
- B. Pseudonym
- C. Nomenclature
- D. Title

Ans. B

195. 'To trickle' means to:

- A. flow in a thin stream
- B. splash water all around
- C. flow in a large stream
- D. pour bucket of water

Ans. A

196. A convalescent meal is a meal specially prepared for:

- A. athletes
- B. old people
- C. sick people
- D. children

Ans. C

197. A person interested in reading books and nothing else

- A. Scholar
- B. Book-keeper
- C. Student
- D. Book-worm

Ans. D

198. That which makes it difficult to recognize the presence of the real nature of somebody or something:

- A. Camouflage
- B. Cover
- C. Mask
- D. Costume

Ans. A

199. A person between ninety to ninety-nine years:

- A. Nonagenarian
- B. Septuagenarian
- C. Octogenarian
- D. Hexagenarian

Ans. A

200. A place where bees are kept:

- A. Apiary
- B. Aviary
- C. Zoo
- D. Sanctuary

Ans. A

Section-B

(2 marks questions)

Short Answer-type Questions:

1. Why was the circus manager worried?

Ans. The circus manager was worried because the attendance in the circus had been falling off and people who did come to the circus did not pay much attention to the show. This would ultimately affect his livelihood.

2. What kind of act did the man agree to show to the circus manager?

Ans. The man told the circus manager that he could dive from a height of sixty feet into a tank of eight feet long by four feet wide and four feet deep.

3. Why did the manager feel that they could not do business with the stranger?

Ans. After the stranger had performed the incredible but dangerous dive, the manager immediately offered him fifteen quid and slowly raised it to a special offer of thirty pounds a week, an amount which they had never paid to anyone in the circus. When the man still shook his head, the circus manager felt that they could not do business with him.

4. Describe the stranger who came to the circus.

Ans. The stranger was a tall, sandy haired fellow with tawny eyes and a straggling moustache. He might have been about thirty-five years of age and wearing an old brown corduroy cap.

5. Describe the king's daughter

Ans. The princess was a blooming beauty who was loved by the king above all humanity. Having inherited the savage blood from her wholly barbaric ancestors, she was hot-blooded, passionate and imperious.

6. What was the main purpose of the amphitheatre?

Ans. The semi- barbaric king built the amphitheatre mainly for the purpose of punishing the guilty and rewarding the innocent through an impartial and incorruptible system of justice. It was also intended to develop the mental energies of his subjects and make them refined and cultured.

7. What did the king do when he discovered the love-affair?

Ans. As soon as the king discovered the love-affair between his daughter and the courtier, he did

not hesitate in exercising his duty in the matter; he immediately ordered for the youth to be thrown into prison and made arrangements for the youth's trial in the public arena.

8. What were 'those fateful portals'?

Ans. They were the two doors which were exactly alike and standing side by side in the arena opposite the king and his court. Behind one door was a ferocious tiger and behind the other was a beautiful lady. They were 'fateful' because either door would decide the fate of the accused.

9. What kind of life did Rama Rao lead in the Extension before his business collapsed?

Ans. Rama Rao, the Malgudi agent of a gramophone company had put into that agency the little money he had inherited as security. His business flourished for five years and this enabled him to keep his wife and children in good comfort. He built a small bungalow in the Extension and was even planning to buy a car.

10. 'Sometimes the news-agent would grumble.'

Why did the news-agent grumble and how did Rama Rao try to pacify him?

Ans. The news-agent grumbled because, when the solutions of the crossword puzzles were out in the journal, Rama Rao waited at his shop to look at the result without paying for it. Rama Rao tried to pacify him with the promise of three years' subscription in advance, if he won the prize.

11. What kind of journal was 'The Captain'?

Ans, 'The Captain' was a journal which consisted of four pages all of which were devoted to crossword puzzles. It offered four thousand rupees to the first prize winners every week. It was this particular journal that Rama Rao came across in the Jubilee Reading Room which ultimately led him to fall prey to a luck-based game.

12. What did Rama Rao do in order to get a job?

Ans. After losing his lucrative business, Rama Rao wore his feet out looking for employment. He sent out a dozen applications a day and personally visited many offices and told them that he had lost his business for no fault of his own. Though everyone sympathized with him, none offered him a job but assured him that he would be informed if there was any opportunity in the future.

13. Describe the red-faced man.

Ans. The red-faced man was a fat man with bulging bloodshot eyes of the palest grey who wore a light fawn coat. He had lost two of his front teeth. While speaking, he would cover his mouth with his hand to hide the missing teeth.

14. How many passengers were there in the compartment and where had they come from?

Ans. There were five passengers in the second-class carriage. They had come from Rome and had spent the night in the compartment because the connecting train to Sulmona would be available only in the morning.

15. What is the benefit, according to the red-faced man, if their sons die young?

Ans. According to the red-faced man, it is better if their sons die young for, they will not be able to see the ugly sides of life, the pettiness, the boredom and bitterness of disillusion. When decent boys die, they die proud and happy doing what they love to do.

16. Why did the fat red-faced man not mourn the death of his son?

Ans. The fat red-faced man never mourned the death of his son because he received a message from his son telling him that he was ending his life in the best possible way. His son was perfectly satisfied when he died.

17. Who was Ratan?

Ans. Ratan was an orphan of about twelve or thirteen who helped the postmaster with household chores. She was illiterate, and it was the postmaster who taught her how to read. She soon became not only a helper but a companion and a confidante.

18. Which memory was far more vividly fixed in Ratan's mind?

Ans. In a conversation with the postmaster, Ratan shared the memories she had of her past. She recalled playing fishing with her younger brother on a rainy day at the edge of a small pond with sticks that they broke off trees. This simple childhood memory remained fixed more vividly in Ratan's mind.

19. How did the postmaster feel when the boat had started to set sail?

Ans. As the boat started to set sail, the postmaster was filled with deep sorrow and guilt for

leaving Ratan behind. He felt a huge anguish when he remembered her grief-stricken face and even thought of going back to fetch her.

20. What would make the half-dead, well-bred young postmaster come alive again?

Ans. The postmaster felt lonely and isolated in the humble village of Ulapur and he longed for the familiar city life. He said that he would come alive again only if a genie could come and cut the leafy trees, made roads and tall buildings which symbolize the comfort and vitality of urban life.

21. Why King Oberon is on bad terms with Queen Titania?

Ans. King Oberon is on bad terms with Queen Titania because she has a sweet and lovely boy as her attendant. Oberon wants to have that boy as the knight of his train but Titania does not want to part with the boy at any cost.

22. Why does Titania refuse to part with the changeling boy?

Ans. Titania refuses to part with the boy because the boy's mother had taken a vow in the order of which Titania would be his patroness. The boy's mother had died while giving birth to him and Titania decided to raise him as her own.

23. What is the power of the magic flower?

Ans. The magic plant, love-in-idleness, makes the one to whom it is applied, fall in love with the first thing he or she sees upon waking whether it be a person, an animal or a monster

24. What is the first mission that Oberon send Puck on and why?

Ans. Oberon sends Puck to get a little western white flower which turned purple after being hit by Cupid's arrow so that he may squeeze the juice of the flower on sleeping Titania's eyelids causing her to blindly love the first creature she sees upon waking.

25. Who is Egeus?

Ans. Egeus is the father of Hermia, the beautiful maiden who has fallen in love with Lysander. He is a respected citizen of Athens and a member of its aristocracy as well. He wants Hermia to marry Demetrius and asks the Duke to enforce the law if she refuses. Thus, he represents strict parental authority in society.

26. Why does Quince want to rehearse in the forest?

Ans. Being content with the parts assigned to them, the craftsmen decide to meet in the forest at night to rehearse the play. Peter Quince feels that it is best to rehearse there, away from town, so as not to be disturbed by people. He also does not want people to know beforehand about what they are going to perform at the Duke's wedding.

27. Who is Bottom?

Ans. Nick Bottom is a character in 'A Midsummer Night's Dream' who provides comic relief through out the play. A weaver by trade, he is famously known for getting his head transformed into that of a donkey by the elusive Puck.

28. What does Oberon plan to do on the night of Duke Theseus' wedding?

Ans. Oberon plans that on the night of the wedding, he along with Titania will ceremoniously and joyfully dance in Duke Theseus' house and bless his house with prosperity.

29. What roles for the play are assigned to the Athenian craftsmen?

Ans. The Athenian craftsmen have decided to put on a short play called 'The Death of Pyramus and Thisbe' as part of the duke's wedding festivities. Quince, being in charge, assigns different roles to the work-men. Bottom is to play the part of Pyramus, Flute is to play the part of Thisbe and the part of the lion will be played by Snug.

30. Why did Oberon order Puck to make the night foggy?

Ans. After learning about the confusion among the four lovers due to Puck's own negligence, Oberon orders him to make the night foggy and lead the lovers astray so that they will not be able to find each other. Then after they fall asleep from weariness, Puck will make things right again by applying the antidote on Lysander's eyes.

Extracts from Poetry section
(3 Marks)

Read the extracts and answer the questions that follow:

1. I could not see the heavy thing they carried;
I only heard 'He never gave a cry'

- (a) Name the poem and the poet.
- (b) What is the heavy thing they carried?
- (c) Who never gave a cry?

Ans. (a) The extract is taken from the poem 'Swimmers' written by Louis Untermeyer.
Ans. (b) The heavy thing mentioned here is the dead body of the swimmer.
Ans. (c) The swimmer who was struggling with the waves never gave a cry for help.

2. I swung my racket at astonished oaks,
My arm still tingling from aggressive strokes.

- (a) Who is 'I' referred to here?
- (b) Why is his arm tingling?
- (c) Where is the speaker heading to?

Ans. (a) The word 'I' here refers to the swimmer or the tennis player.
Ans. (b) His arm is tingling because he has just been playing an aggressive game of Tennis.
Ans. (c) The speaker is heading to the bay.

3. Bowed by the weight of centuries he leans
Upon his hoe and gazes on the ground.

- (a) Name the poem and the poet.
- (b) Who is 'he' mentioned in the extract?
- (c) What is the weight of centuries mentioned here?

Ans. (a) The extract is taken from the poem, 'The Man With The Hoe' written by Edwin Markham.
Ans. (b) 'He' is a labourer working in his field. He represents all the labourers who have been suffering for centuries.
Ans. (c) It refers to the sufferings, injustice and exploitations suffered by the labour class.

4. Through this dread shape humanity betrayed,
Plundered, profaned and disinherited.

- (a) What is the 'dread shape' referred to here?
- (b) Why is the shape dreadful?

(c) How is humanity betrayed?

Ans. (a) The 'dread shape' refers to the man always bending over his hoe.
Ans. (b) The shape is dreadful because he has been exploited by the rich sections of society. His body has completely changed from years of hard work.
Ans. (c) Humanity is betrayed when the labourers have been deprived of their rights to a life of minimum comfort and dignity.

5. Thus Nature spake- The work was done-
How soon my Lucy's race was run!

- (a) Name the poem and the poet.
- (b) Who is Lucy?
- (c) What is meant by 'The work was done'?

Ans. (a) The extract is taken from the poem, 'The Education of Nature' written by William Wordsworth.
Ans. (b) Lucy is a young girl adopted by Nature.
Ans. (c) It means that Nature has completed its work in shaping and educating Lucy.

6. Then Nature said, 'A lovelier flower
On earth was never sown
This child, I to myself will take

- (a) Who is compared to the loveliest flower on earth?
- (b) How old is she?
- (c) What does Nature decide to do with the 'child'?

Ans. (a) Lucy is compared to the loveliest flower that has ever been planted on earth.
Ans. (b) She is three years old.
Ans. (c) Nature decides to adopt the little girl and to mould her into a perfect lady.

7. If you can meet with Triumph and Disaster
And treat two imposters just the same.

- (a) Name the poem and the poet.
- (b) What does 'Triumph' and 'Disaster' mean?
- (c) How should one treat the two imposters?

Ans. (a) The extract is taken from the poem 'If' written by Rudyard Kipling.
Ans. (b) The word, 'Triumph' means victory or success and 'Disaster' means failure.

Ans. (c) One should treat the imposters just the same. One should maintain a balanced perspective and not be swayed by either triumph or disaster.

8. If you can keep your head when all about you
Are losing theirs and blaming it on you,

- (a) To whom does the poet address this poem?
- (b) What does the poet mean by 'if you can keep your head'?
- (c) When should we maintain composure?

Ans. (a) The poet, Rudyard Kipling addresses this poem to his son.

Ans. (b) The poet means that one should try to remain calm and collected when others are losing composure.

Ans. (c) The poet emphasises the importance of maintaining our composure when facing blame or criticism.

9. One pregnant woman
and a couple of cows
named Gopi and Brinda as usual.

- (a) Name the poem and the poet.
- (b) Who is the speaker?
- (c) What is common between the pregnant woman and the cows?

Ans. (a) The extract is taken from the poem, 'A River' written A.K. Ramanujan.

Ans. (b) The speaker of these lines is the poet himself.

Ans. (c) The common thing between them is that they were drowned in the flood.

10. The river has water enough
to be poetic
about only once a year.

- (a) Which particular river is the poet talking about here?
- (b) Where is the river situated?
- (c) Which aspect of the river appeals to the old and the new poets?

Ans. (a) The poet is talking about the river Vaikai or Vaigai.

Ans. (b) The river is situated in the city of Madurai.

Ans. (c) The flooded river during the monsoon season appeals to the old and the new poets.

Section-C

(5 marks questions)

Long Answer- type Questions:

1. 'We all have our share of personal sorrows, but we cannot compare them.' Discuss how the above statement is proved in the story 'War'.

Ans. The story 'War' portrays the depth of human sorrow in the light of a war situation. Luigi Pirandello shows us through the story that human beings are emotional and that each individual's sorrow is unique. This is illustrated through the interaction of the passengers sitting in the second-class carriage of the train going to Sulmona. All of them had some or other sorrows hidden in their hearts. Each passenger carried his own grief, having sent their sons and nephews to the front. However, as they conversed, it becomes evident that sorrow is deeply personal and cannot truly be measured against another's. At first, the passengers seemed to compete in expressing whose suffering is greater. The husband of the bulky woman and his wife mourned their only son who had been sent to the front while others shared similar losses. This led to a kind of contest of grief, as each believed his pain to be more unique or heavier.

Then, one fat man in the carriage surprised them by revealing that his son had already died in battle. Unlike the others, he claimed he was at peace because his son died a hero and died in the best way possible. He spoke as if he had overcome personal sorrow making the other passengers fall silent, perhaps feeling their own grief was less significant compared to what the fat man had gone through. When he finally broke down at the end, it shows that grief cannot be weighed or measured. This moment proves that no matter how much we try to rationalize or compare our sorrows, the pain of personal loss is unique to each person and can never be compared.

2. Compare Rama Rao's life and his family's before and after the collapse of his business.

Ans. Rama Rao was the Malgudi agent of a gramophone company in Northern India. He had inherited some money, which he had deposited in the company as security. It was an independent and profitable job and his business flourished for five years. He even built a small bungalow at the

Extension and was planning to buy a car. Before the loss, his wife and children lived a comfortable life. His wife was always sparkling with flowers and bright dresses. She had friendly neighbours, attended a women's club and had everything to keep her happy. The children were sent to a fashionable nursery school and would play with a dozen other children in their compound and were given new clothes every three months. They had a cook, servants and were well taken care of by Rama Rao.

When the gramophone company collapsed, everything took an opposite turn. Rama Rao found himself on the streets. The life style of the family changed drastically. The money in the bank slowly melted away. They let out their bungalow and moved to a small house behind the market. Rama Rao tried to look for a job but in vain. He turned to crossword puzzles but suffered mentally for he never won and there were also quarrels with his wife. All this had its impact on the family life. Their standard of living came down. Having sent away the cook and the servant, she remained cooped up in the kitchen. His children were sent to a free primary school. They had no friends and played at the backyard of the house. Their clothes showed tears and frays. Rama Rao slowly began to lose interest in the welfare of his family and ultimately, his depression led him to even try committing suicide.

3. "... he did not think at all of that royal personage- his eyes were fixed upon the princess, who sat to the right of her father".

Why were the eyes of the young man transfixed on the princess from the time he entered the arena?

Ans. The accused who dared to love the semi-barbaric king's only daughter, was brought to the arena for his trial on the appointed day. As the youth advanced into the arena, all eyes were fixed on him but he looked at neither the king nor the spectators, for his eyes were fixed only upon the princess who sat on the right side of her father. He was certain that she had discovered the mystery of the doors. He knew that her resolute nature would not allow her to sit still and he was sure that she would use every trick to procure the secret. With hope in his soul, he looked at the princess and immediately knew that she had succeeded in finding out behind which door crouched the

ferocious tiger and behind which door stood the fair lady. With a quick and anxious glance, he asked his beloved which door he should open, trusting her fully to help him make the right choice. No one but the princess saw the signal as every eye was totally on the courtier. Sitting there paler and whiter than anyone in that vast amphitheatre, she received his message and knew that she would have to answer his question quickly. She made her decision in an instant and she raised her right hand from the cushioned parapet and made a quick slight movement toward the right. No one saw or understood the significance of that raised hand except her lover. Grateful to have received the signal, the young man turned and wasted no time in walking decisively across the empty space. Without the slightest doubt, he went and confidently opened the door on the right.

4. What made the postmaster say that a genie out of an Arab tale would make him come alive again in the village of Ulapur?

The postmaster felt like a fish out of water in the remote village of Ulapur, where he had been appointed. Coming from the bustling and cultured city of Calcutta (Kolkata), he found it difficult to adjust to the simple, quiet rural life. The agents and employees who worked at the indigo factory were not suitable companions for an educated man like him. Thus, he could not connect with the villagers, and he found no intellectual or emotional companionship. Moreover, he had very little and sometimes, no work to do at all. All he could do was look at the trees and the clouds in the sky and write poems about the happiness he felt watching them. In reality, he felt trapped and isolated and he longed for the familiar city life. His loneliness made him think that he would feel alive again only if a genie from an Arab tale could come and cut down all the leafy trees, build roads and tall buildings which symbolize the comfort and vitality of urban life. This longing for an impossible, magical escape showed his inability to adapt or find comfort in his surroundings. He referred to himself as 'half-dead' which suggests how drained and spiritless he felt in that environment.

5. What is the 'Wall of Death' and why was the circus manager against it?

Ans. The 'Wall of Death' is a dangerous feat where stunt riders on motorcycles or cars ride along the inside walls of a large vertical wooden cylinder at high speed. In this particular circus, it was performed with a lion on the rider's back.

The attendance at the circus had been falling off day by day which had them greatly worried. The manager's wife suggested introducing a dangerous act in order to draw bigger crowds with the hope to revive the past glory of their circus. She believed that modern audiences would never be bored by such acts that could hold their interest more than the acts which they already had. Hearing her subtle suggestion, the manager's chest muscles twitched under his thin shirt for he was not in favour of the 'Wall of Death' or any act similar to it. He reminded her how a performer had died while performing the risky feat. The tragic accident deeply affected the whole circus community and left a bitter and scary impression on everyone. A crowd of people came to the circus after the incident not as audiences of their show but they only wanted to see the spot where the performer had died. The circus employees as well as the performers became upset and demoralized. Shock, fear and grief led to their inability to perform well for a long time. Taking all these factors into consideration, the circus manager told his wife that he was against the re-introduction of a dangerous act. Moreover, he added that it would be quite difficult to find a man who could perform such an attractive but risky feat.

6. Describe the river during the summer season.

Ans. A. K. Ramanujan depicts the ugliness of the river Vaigai in Madurai during its dry state. During the hot summer, the river is dry and only a very small thin stream of water flows, which is a vast contrast to the glorious floods that occur in the rainy season. One can see the ugliness of the river once the water recedes. It dries to a trickle thus exposing the sand in the river-bed resembling human ribs. Women's hair and straw are also seen clogging the water-gates obstructing the free flow of water. The rusty bars under the bridges with patches of repair all over them are also exposed. One can also notice the stones on the bed of the river. The stones, wet from the receding water, are

compared to sleepy crocodiles and the dry ones are likened to shaven water buffaloes lounging in the hot sun. This suggests a sense of lifelessness and passivity. Hence, the poets, both old and new, neither sings nor focuses on this aspect of the river which greatly angers A. K. Ramanujan.

7. Bring out the significance of the title, 'The Education of Nature'

Ans. 'The Education of Nature' is a representative poem of Wordsworth who firmly believes Nature to be a complete teacher, mother and guide. The title itself holds deep symbolic and philosophical meaning reflecting his romantic belief that nature is a powerful moral and spiritual teacher that can mould a child's personality and bring about his all-round development. He establishes nature as the paradigm of all teachers, sages and educational institutions. In this poem, Wordsworth writes about Lucy, an innocent girl, being shaped and moulded not by society, but by the natural world—mountains, rivers, the skies, and the solitude of the countryside. Nature becomes a nurturing force, teaching Lucy qualities such as simplicity, kindness, strength, and grace. The poet believes that the different agents of Nature such as clouds, storms, rocks and trees etc. would help her in their own ways and provide the best dwelling place for her to grow naturally as a young woman. Wordsworth believes that true wisdom and virtue come from living in harmony with nature, away from the corrupting influences of urban life and materialism. By titling the poem 'The Education of Nature,' he challenges conventional ideas about how individuals, especially children, should be raised and taught.

8. How has Edwin Markham described the physical and mental state of the man with the hoe?

Ans. The man with the hoe is the victim of the world's collective greed and selfishness. The inhuman exploitation and oppression through ages has completely distorted him physically and mentally. His back is bent by carrying the burden of the world. His face is distorted, his jaw has become loose and his brow has slanted back. He leans upon his hoe for support and gazes on the ground with a vacant look on his face. He is so dazed and emotionless that the poet compares him to an ox, which is a beast of burden. His expressionless face shows the emptiness of life lived through ages. The man with the hoe has become insensitive to

joy and sorrow, he neither complains nor grieves at his piteous state and all glimmer of hope has disappeared. He has lost all divine, angelic qualities like intellect, spirituality and the ability to appreciate music and beautiful things. In fact, the man has been reduced to an ugly thing with a deadened soul.

9. Give the character sketch of Lysander.

Ans. Lysander is one of the central characters in William Shakespeare's play 'A Midsummer Night's Dream'. He is portrayed as a romantic and passionate young man who is deeply in love with Hermia. Lysander's love for Hermia is intense and genuine. Hermia's father, Egeus opposes the match and wants her to marry Demetrius. Despite the obstacles they face, Lysander and Hermia remain committed to each other. He shows determination when he plans to elope in order to escape the Athenian law. In the woods, he proves to be a gentleman for he respects Hermia's wishes to lay separately. When spellbound by the juice of the magic flower, Lysander falls madly in love with Helena. This sudden change in affection causes a great deal of confusion and conflict among the lovers. Lysander becomes determined to win over Helena's heart and his loyalty towards Hermia is completely forgotten. He shows courage by being willing to have a sword fight with Demetrius for Helena clearly indicating that is not afraid of dying for the sake of love. Puck finally gives him the antidote and his true love for Hermia is restored. He realizes the mistake and apologizes to Hermia for his temporary infatuation with Helena. Hermia's father, ultimately accepts their relationship and allows Lysander and Hermia to get married.

Lysander's character in 'A Midsummer Night's Dream' is a blend of romantic ideals and external influences. While he initially embodies passionate love, his journey through the play reveals the complexities of human emotions and the impact of outside forces on one's inner-self.

10. "The hours that we have spent together never wishing to be parted-have you forgotten all of that?" Name the speaker and justify the statement from the speaker's point of view.

Ans. The speaker here is Helena and she speaks these words to her friend, Hermia.

Helena and Hermia have grown up together and this friendship is built on shared experiences, trust and love for another. However, this friendship is tested by the confusion caused by the magical flower and they become angry towards each other. Helena thinks that Demetrius and Lysander, along with Hermia are in a plot together to ridicule her when out of the blue, both the men profess their undying love for her. So she reminds Hermia of their friendship and the joyful moment spent together never wishing to be parted. She recalls their school days working together like sisters with their needles, while sitting on one cushion singing one song and sharing the same thought. Helena also compares their connection to 'two cherries on one stem, seeming to be parted, but yet united'. Helena adds that they are like a coat of arms that separated two people but having one heart. Helena is sad and feels betrayed to see her best friend joining hands with Lysander and Demetrius in mocking her. She feels that all these memories have been casually cast aside and forgotten by Hermia.

11. What advice does the duke give Hermia with regards to obeying her father?

Ans. Egeus goes to Theseus, the Duke of Athens to lodge a complaint against his daughter, Hermia for she has refused to marry Demetrius, the man of his choice. Egeus wants the Athenian law to be imposed whereby a father has the right to choose the daughter's husband. Hearing this, the Duke advises Hermia to follow her father's instructions rather than her own desire. He tells her to marry the man of her father's choice by saying that Demetrius is worthy and gentle while Lysander lacks her father's approval. The Duke also explains that her father gave her life and so should be looked upon as a God. Her father is also compared to a sculptor who has shaped her and so has the right to disfigure her as he wishes. So Hermia must consider her decision from her father's point of view while choosing the worthier of the two young men. Theseus understands that he cannot work against nor change the laws of the country. So he gives Hermia four days to think about her decision to marry Demetrius. If she continues to remain adamant or disagree with her father's choice, then as per law, she has to be either executed or sent to the nunnery as punishment.

12. What happens whenever Oberon and Titania quarrel?

Ans. Oberon and Titania, the King and Queen of Fairyland are in bad terms as they both want to have the changeling boy as their attendant. So, they quarrel whenever and wherever they meet which in turn makes a great impact on nature as well as humans. Their quarrel brings about weather disturbances resulting in terrible rainstorms, high winds and occasional floods. The winds tired of singing in vain, suck up water from the seas and fall as rain on land causing little rivers to overflow their banks. The labour of the farmers and the oxen bear no result because crops will not grow and the green corn rots before the crop grows a silky beard. The sheep pen is flooded and crows become fat from feasting on the dead meat. Covered in mud, the paths formerly used by lovers have disappeared. In summer, the crimson roses are covered with frost, while in winter, rose buds are seen everywhere. The seasons are confused as well and the world no longer knows which season will come and when. Because of their quarrel, men are deprived of the season they love. Hence, every evil occurrence originated from their quarrel.

SECTION-D
(COMPOSITION)

Advertisement / Comprehension
(Marks - 4)

1. Your neighbour wishes to give the top floor of her house for rent. Help her draft an advertisement for the classified column of the local newspaper.

Ans.

TO LET

Available on rent, a four bedroom top –floor house in colony Block III, good location, well-ventilated and spacious rooms, two attached toilets and 24 hours running water. Rent negotiable. Interested family can contact G Tariang, Umplingor call 9811001100 before 7 pm.

2. Your uncle wants a receptionist for his ‘Green Resort’, Shillong, Meghalaya. Help him draft an advertisement for the classified column of the local newspaper.

Ans.

SITUATION VACANT

Required a smart, well qualified and experienced receptionist for ‘Green Resort’, Shillong. Minimum qualification: Bachelor’s degree in Hotel Management, 2-3 years of work experience, age between 21-35 years and well versed in Khasi, English and Hindi. Salary negotiable. For more details contact 9756111100 or email@greenResort.com

Comprehension (4 Marks)

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

1. The invention of the internet has completely transformed human life. From communication to education, shopping to entertainment, almost every aspect of our daily routine is now connected to the internet. In the past, people had to wait for days or even weeks to receive a letter. Today, emails and instant messages allow us to communicate with anyone around the world within seconds. The internet has also changed the way we gain knowledge. Students can attend online classes, watch educational videos, and access libraries with just a few clicks. Shopping has become easier as well—products can be ordered from home and delivered to our doorsteps. Social networking sites help people stay in touch and share moments, regardless of distance.

However, these conveniences come with their own set of challenges. Issues like cyberbullying, online fraud, data theft, and the spread of fake news are increasing day by day. Children and teenagers are especially vulnerable to these dangers. That is why it is important for users to be aware of how to use the internet safely and responsibly. Being respectful and thoughtful while interacting online is just as important as being polite in real life. In conclusion, the internet is a powerful tool that has many benefits, but we must use it wisely and cautiously to protect ourselves and others.

1. How has the internet transformed communication?
2. What are three benefits of the internet mentioned in the passage?
3. Why are children and teenagers more at risk online?
4. Give a suitable title for this passage.

ANSWERS:

1. The internet has made communication much faster and easier, allowing emails and messages to be sent instantly across the world.
2. Access to education, easier shopping, and staying connected through social media.
3. Children and teenagers are more at risk because they are more likely to be unaware of online dangers and may not always use the internet safely.

4. The Internet: A Powerful Tool with Responsibilities

2. Mark had failed the entrance exam for the third time. Each failure had chipped away at his confidence like waves eroding a rock. His parents had been supportive, but he could see the disappointment in their eyes. One morning, he found his grandfather in the garden, trimming the plants. “You look tired,” his grandfather said without turning around. Mark sat beside him and sighed. “I don’t think I’m meant to succeed. Maybe I should stop trying.”

The old man smiled gently and handed Mark a small bamboo stick.

“Do you know why bamboo is special?” he asked. Mark shook his head.

“When a bamboo seed is planted, it takes five years to grow even an inch. But beneath the soil, it’s developing roots strong enough to support its tall structure. Once it starts growing, it can rise several feet in just weeks.”

Mark looked at the stick and then at his grandfather.

“You’re like the bamboo,” his grandfather said.

“Maybe your roots are still growing.”

Mark smiled for the first time in weeks. That day, he picked up his books again—not because he had to, but because he believed in his roots.

1. Why was Mark feeling hopeless at the beginning of the story?
2. How did Mark’s grandfather try to encourage him?
3. What message does the story convey?
4. Find a word in the story that means ‘gradually wearing away’.

ANSWERS:

1. Mark was feeling hopeless because he had failed the entrance exam three times.
2. His grandfather encouraged him by telling the story of the bamboo plant to show that growth takes time.
3. The story conveys that perseverance and patience are important, and that unseen progress is still valuable.
4. Eroding

Amplification

(5 Marks)

1. Necessity is the mother of invention.

Ans. Necessity is the best teacher. It is also known as the mother of invention. When necessity arises no one can deny its severe demands and act according to its dictates. Under the pressure of necessity men do wonderful things. From telephone cables to wireless radio waves, it has changed our communication levels. And from watching the birds fly, to doing it ourselves it has opened up the world. From back breaking jobs to gliding across the floor it has revolutionized our needs. These were all innovations of the nineteen hundreds. The decade that started the century at the technological revolution day to day life. The A.M. radio, air conditioner, aeroplanes were all the inventions that shocked the world. From tabletop computers, laptop computers to palmtop computers, information technology has aided to turn the world smaller into a virtual global village and is continuously being changed every minute to suit our needs and demands. Hence, it is the duty of all men to take full advantage of necessity. The youth should turn necessity into their benefit and the benefit of their country. It was at times of necessity that some men have taken to the helm of affairs, fought battles and also won them. It was also under necessity that countries have worked miracles. Necessity can be the real benefactor.

2. Strike while the iron is hot

Ans. Everything has to be done at the proper time. This maxim involves two factors choosing the most suitable time and acting promptly to win an advantage. While the iron is in the furnace, only when it is heated to a particular temperature, it can be beaten into the required shape; the right moment is to be chosen to hammer the iron. In the same way, for raising good crops, sowing, planting and harvesting should be done at the right time: otherwise the crops fail. The stem of a plant can be bent in the way we want, only when it is tender but not after it grows into a tree. To implant ideas of right and wrong, to inculcate good behavior and help form good habits in one, it is the business of the parent to choose as most suitable, one's early life(i.e. childhood) which is the formative period of a person's life.

Summary Writing / Diary Writing

(5 marks)

Summarise the given passage:

1. Speaking in public is as difficult as singing or acting, and it ought to be a careful rehearsal; even more careful, because one of the aims of the public speaker is to appear entirely spontaneous. The great speakers of Greece and Rome used to prepare an important speech as carefully as an opera star nowadays studies a new role. After writing about a dozen times, they would deliver it before few trusted friends, critics and tutors and yet the whole thing appeared not a highly elaborate product of art, but a genuine outpouring of real and overwhelming emotion. That is why we still study the speeches of men like Cicero; a single page of them contains the result of more concentrated thought, active experience, intricate psychological knowledge and training in language than modern speakers can command in a whole lifetime.

Ans. Public speaking is an art which is as difficult as singing and acting. Classical speakers used to master their speeches in private before delivering to the people. That is why their speeches contained more deep thought and training in language, emotional enough to touch the heart and mind of the hearer. They are no doubt better than modern speakers can command.

2. From the moment we are born, we cannot live alone. We stand in constant need of support from all around us, for body and soul and spirit. We need clothes that other men make, houses, which men build, food which other men produce. We earn our living by working for others; others earn their living by working for us.

As children we need our parents to be our comforters to take care of us. We cannot live a day without our peers. We need teachers to educate, books and masters to teach us trades. And when we have learned it and settle ourselves in life, we need laws made by other men who died hundreds of years before we were born, to secure for us, our rights and property, to secure our comfort in our station, and we need friends to comfort us in sorrow.

Ans. We need support from all around us from the moment we are born. We need clothes, houses, food, and teachers to educate us, laws to secure our rights and property, and friends to comfort us in our

sorrow and share our joys. We earn our living by working for others, and we need our parents to be our comforters to take care of us.

Diary Entry (5 Marks)

1. Your school has organised a “No Tobacco” campaign recently. Write a diary entry describing your participation and experience gathered through the campaign.

Day: Friday
Date: 05th April 2025
Time: 8:00 pm

Dear Diary,

Today, our school organised a “No Tobacco” campaign and I participated in it. The campaign is to make people aware about the harmful effects of tobacco. It was a day filled with various activities to educate and encourage everyone to live a tobacco-free life.

The morning began with a rally where I along with other students carried colourful placards with anti-tobacco messages, slogans and we marched around the locality. It was inspiring to see the students actively participating in it. After the rally, there were a series of competitions including poster-making where students showcased their creativity. I participated in the essay writing competition, where I poured my thoughts into words describing the health risks associated with smoking and chewing tobacco. In the afternoon, a debate competition was held on the topic “No Tobacco” where the students passionately presented their arguments for and against tobacco use and its impact on individuals and society. The event concluded with an informative session by our Principal, who congratulated us on the success of the campaign.

It was a day of learning, engagement and collective commitment towards a healthier future. I feel proud to be a part of this campaign that aims to protect people from the pervasive threat of tobacco. These activities inspired everyone and hence we took a pledge and said ‘No’ to tobacco.

Goodnight
XYZ

2. Your school had arranged for a trip to an orphanage. Write a diary entry about your experience and your feelings on that day.

Day: Saturday
Date: 23rd June 2025
Time: 9:30 pm

Dear Diary,

Last week, our class teacher told us that she and a few other teachers would be taking us on a field trip to an orphanage located on the outskirts of town. We were all excited and got our parents involved by begging them to contribute to the things we were going to buy for the orphans. I had always enjoyed such activities, but I had no idea that this particular day would leave such a deep mark in my heart. As our bus reached the orphanage, we saw a group of children waiting for us, their faces lit with happiness to see visitors. The place was small and modest, but it echoed with laughter and warmth. My friends and I began distributing the items we had brought. Some of the kids hugged their new sweaters tightly, while others eagerly opened packets of biscuits and sweets.

In the middle of all this, I met a boy around my age, but much thinner and shorter. He had the brightest smile I had ever seen. His name is Robert. He told me about his dreams of becoming a doctor so he could help other poor children. Despite having so little, his heart was full of hope. We played together, shared stories, and even sang songs. When it was time to leave, Robert held my hand tightly and said, “Come back again.” It touched me deeply! I realized how much small acts of kindness mean to those who have so little. On the way back, I thought about how fortunate I was and how I often took things for granted. I promise myself that I will continue helping those in need, not just once a year, but whenever I can.

Glad to share my experience with you.....until next time.

Goodnight
XYZ

Essay Writing (8 marks)

(An essay can be roughly divided into three units-

i) The introduction

ii) The body- contains all the ideas, concepts and facts concerning the subject. It should be divided into paragraphs and follow a logical sequence.

iii) The conclusion

1. The Advantages and Disadvantages of Being Young.

Youth is often called the golden phase of life. It is the time when a person is full of energy, passion, curiosity and hope. Everything seems possible and the future appears bright and full of opportunities. All people go through the stage of youth, when they are no longer children but not yet adults. Everyone evaluate their young years in their own way, i.e. some enjoy being young and some want to grow up as soon as possible. However being young is not always easy. It has both advantages and disadvantages that shape a person's journey through life.

One of the main advantages of being young is having good health and high energy levels. They are usually physically strong and mentally sharp. They do not have health related issues like the elderly. Young people may also get sick but their body tends to regenerate more efficiently. Another great benefit is the freedom to make choices and explore different paths. Youth is a time to dream big, set goals and work towards them without being burdened by too many responsibilities. Moreover, young people have a fresh perspective and a strong desire to learn which helps them grow as individuals. Many technologies, innovation and social movements are led by the youth because of their creativity, courage and determination.

However, there are several disadvantages of being young. One major challenge is the lack of experience. Young people may make mistakes in judgment or fall into bad habits due to peer pressure. They may also face academic pressure, career confusion and emotional ups and downs. At this age, they may feel misunderstood which can lead to frustration, anxiety or loneliness. Young people are financially dependent on their parents which can limit their freedom.

In conclusion being young is both exciting and challenging. It is a time full of dreams, energy and possibilities but also full of doubts, pressure and mistakes. With the right support and guidance,

young people can make the most of this important phase and build a strong foundation for the future.

2. A Trip ToThe Most Beautiful Picnic Spot

Picnics are one of the simplest yet most delightful ways to spend time with family and friends. They offer a welcome break from our daily routine and provide a chance to relax in the lap of nature. Whether it is a park, a riverside, a beach or a mountain top, a good picnic spot fills our hearts with joy and wonder. Surrounded by fresh air, greenery and natural beauty, we forget our worries and create happy memories that last a lifetime. A picnic is not just about food and games – it is about bonding with others and appreciating the world around us.

Last summer, my fun-loving uncle organized a picnic cum family reunion to Sohra, also known as Cherrapunji, which is one of the most beautiful places one could ever hope to see. Sohra is famous for its beautiful waterfalls, caves, green hills, and cloudy skies and one can never tire of its natural beauty no matter how many times one visits. From the moment we heard about it, my cousins and I were filled with excitement. The adults planned our meals, packed bags with snacks and games, and made sure to carry our cameras to capture the stunning sights

We started our journey early in the morning from Shillong. As our bus made its way along the winding roads, we were treated to breathtaking views of rolling hills covered in mist. The cool breeze, the smell of fresh earth, and the sight of clouds floating so close made the ride magical. When we reached Sohra, it felt like we had stepped into a dream. The entire area was lush green, with deep valleys and towering cliffs. We chose a spot near the famous 'Nohkalikai Falls' for our picnic. The roar of the waterfalls, the sight of the water plunging from a great height and the rainbow that formed in the spray made it a picture-perfect scene.

Our mothers excitedly spread out the mats on a grassy patch and took out the vegetables and fruits that had to be cut. All the children and young adults quickly snatched the game equipment like balls, rackets, bats etc. and we joyfully played on the big grassy meadow. At about 11:30 am, we were called to have our lunch. Later, we decided to explore the surroundings. My uncle took the young ones of the family on a short hike to a nearby viewpoint from where we could see the plains of Bangladesh far in the distance. The clouds drifted

around us as if we were walking through them. Some of us tried to capture the beauty in our cameras, but no photo could truly do justice to what we saw. Before leaving, we sat quietly for a while, taking in the peace and beauty of Sohra.

The trip taught me how wonderful nature is and how important it is to protect such places. That day at Sohra remains one of the happiest and most memorable days of my life.
